

- c. **Browser exploits:** They're designed to take advantage of vulnerabilities in a web browser or software that can be launched via a web browser such as a Flash player, PDF reader or image viewer. Simply by visiting a web page, an unsuspecting user can trigger a browser exploit that can install malware or perform other actions on a device. Such attacks are a significant concern on devices where apps can be downloaded outside of official markets because malware distributed through web sites can evade the greater scrutiny that markets provide

3. Network threats:

- a. **Wi-Fi sniffing:** This can compromise the data transferred over a Wi-Fi network. If the app or the webpage doesn't use proper security by not encrypting data, it may be easily intercepted by anyone listening across an unsecured local wireless network. While the tools for Wi-Fi sniffing facilitate targeted rather than broad-based attacks, the increased use of free Wi-Fi in airports, cafes and other public places has increased the likelihood that Wi-Fi traffic, including account information, can be intercepted.
- b. **Network exploits:** The flaws in your software on your mobile operating system can be exploited by attackers using Bluetooth or Wi-Fi.



A single "s" can mean the difference between secure and insecure

Network exploits often don't require any user intervention, making them especially dangerous when used to automatically propagate malware.

- 4. **Physical threats:** Since the mobile is a portable device, it can be easily lost or stolen. Besides the financial loss, there's the loss of all private and sensitive data.

How they spread

The most common technique hackers use is called Repackaging. This tactic involves taking a legitimate application like Gmail/Gtalk and modifying it to include the malicious code. The attacker then hosts this infected app on his web site. This way when a user installs the infected app, the code runs in the background so the user has no idea that his device is infected. The